



DEPARTMENT OF THE ARMY
TASK FORCE 20
1930 14th ST
FORT POLK, LA 17459

MEMORANDUM OF UNDERSTANDING

15DEC2025

TO: ALL PERSONNEL

FROM: COL J. FORD, COMMANDING OFFICER, TASK FORCE 20

SUBJECT: SECURITY CLASSIFICATIONS

1. APPLICABILITY. This memorandum applies to all Department of Defense personnel, Other Government Agency (OGA) personnel, and Civilian contractors assigned to Task Force 20.

2. SCOPE. This memorandum outlines the entry requirements, expectations, rules, and regulations to which all personnel assigned to Task Force 20 are subject.

3. CLASSIFICATIONS. The following classifications are used to denote the required level of protection, access control, and handling for all Task Force 20 information, communications, and documents. All personnel are required to adhere to the requirements of each classification level, as applicable, at all times.

(1) CONTROLLED UNCLASSIFIED INFORMATION (CUI)

- I. **DEFINITION.** Information that is unclassified but requires safeguarding or dissemination controls in accordance with applicable authorities.
- II. **HANDLING.** CUI will be clearly marked "CUI" at a minimum. Distribution is limited to authorized personnel with a need-to-know. Do not post CUI to public channels. Store electronically only on approved systems; use encryption for electronic transmission when feasible. Dispose of CUI by shredding or approved destruction methods.

(2) UNCLASSIFIED (UC)

- I. **DEFINITION.** Information that is not classified and is approved for routine organizational use; it may still be sensitive operationally and must be handled responsibly.
- II. **HANDLING.** Mark as "UNCLASSIFIED" or "UC" when appropriate. Share only through official channels. Public release requires explicit authorization from Task Force 20 command staff or designated authority.



(3) **CLASSIFIED (C)**

- I. **DEFINITION.** Information requiring formal protection under classified information controls. Within Task Force 20, "CLASSIFIED (C)" denotes the baseline classified level used by the organization and is handled with controls equivalent to a "CONFIDENTIAL" baseline.
- II. **HANDLING.** Access is limited to personnel with the appropriate clearance, formal access authorization, and need-to-know. Store only in approved security containers/approved secure systems. Discuss only in approved secure spaces. Transmit only via authorized secure means. Destroy only via approved classified destruction procedures.

(4) **SECRET (S)**

- I. **DEFINITION.** Information whose unauthorized disclosure could reasonably be expected to cause serious damage to national security.
- II. **(2) HANDLING.** Access requires appropriate clearance, formal authorization, and need-to-know. Storage, discussion, transmission, reproduction, and destruction must comply with SECRET-level controls and approved secure systems and locations.

(5) **TOP SECRET (TS)**

- I. **DEFINITION.** Information whose unauthorized disclosure could reasonably be expected to cause exceptionally grave damage to national security.
- II. **HANDLING.** Access requires TOP SECRET eligibility, formal authorization, and need-to-know. Storage, discussion, transmission, reproduction, and destruction must comply with TOP SECRET controls and be conducted only through approved TOP SECRET systems, locations, and processes.



(6) TOP SECRET – SPECIAL ACCESS REQUIRED (TS-SAR)

- I. DEFINITION.** TOP SECRET information protected within a Special Access Program (SAP) or equivalent compartment requiring explicit indoctrination, additional eligibility, and specific written access approval.
- II. HANDLING.** Access is limited to personnel specifically read into the program and listed on the access roster. Store and process only within approved SAR/SAP channels and facilities. Do not reproduce, extract, or summarize without explicit program authorization. Discuss only within approved SAR/SAP spaces and communications systems.

4. MARKING REQUIREMENTS. All Task Force 20 documents and communications will be marked with the appropriate classification at the time of creation. At a minimum, markings will include the overall classification (e.g., CUI, UC, C, S, TS, TS-SAR) in a prominent location. When required by policy or operational direction, apply portion markings and include distribution controls.

5. HANDLING REQUIREMENTS. All personnel will:

- (1) Apply need-to-know principles to all information, regardless of classification.
- (2) Use only approved systems, repositories, and channels for storage and transmission.
- (3) Prevent unauthorized disclosure through disciplined communications practices, including avoiding classified/CUI discussion in uncontrolled environments.
- (4) Secure physical materials (printouts, notes, media) commensurate with their classification and ensure approved destruction when no longer required.
- (5) When in doubt, treat information at the higher classification level until guidance is received from Task Force 20 command staff or designated security authority.



6. REPORTING & ENFORCEMENT. Any suspected compromise, improper handling, or unauthorized disclosure will be reported immediately through the chain of command and to the designated security authority. Violations may result in disciplinary action, removal of access, reassignment, or discharge from Task Force 20, as appropriate.

7. AGREEMENT. All members and applicants must agree to comply with the classification definitions and handling requirements stated above. Failure to agree will result in immediate application denial or discharge from Task Force 20.

J. Ford

J. Ford, Colonel, United States Army
Commanding Officer
Task Force 20